SOLAR ACCELERATOR

7-Day Sales Rep
Certification Program

DAY 1

The Foundation of Excellence

Modules 1.1–1.8 · Vision · Onboarding · Culture · Solar Industry · Technology · Identity · Utility Bills · Wrap-Up

You Aren't Learning a Job. You're Joining a Movement.

MODULE 1.1

Welcome & Vision Casting

Why You Are Here — and Where This Takes You

MODULE 1.1 — WELCOME & VISION CASTING

Day 1: The Foundation of Excellence

1. Understand the company mission, vision, and values
2. Visualize the earning potential in solar sales
3. Identify the 4 Stages of Competence — and where you're starting
4. Establish classroom ground rules for maximum learning

Learning Objectives: What You'll Have by 5 PM Today

🎯 MISSION

- Understand what this company stands for and why it matters
- Know the difference between selling panels and creating financial freedom
- Be able to articulate the company's core values with conviction

💰 EARNING POTENTIAL

- See the real income trajectory for average, good, and elite reps
- Understand why solar is one of the only commission businesses with no ceiling
- Know exactly what activity levels produce which income levels

🧠 COMPETENCE MAP

- Identify the 4 Stages of Competence
- Know which stage you're in right now — and what comes next
- Understand why the 'Pit of Despair' is a sign of growth, not failure

📋 GROUND RULES

- Commit to the classroom standards that maximize learning
- Set up the accountability structures that will support Week 1
- Leave today with clarity on what happens tomorrow morning

📋 *TRAINER NOTE: By 5 PM today, every rep in this room will understand why this industry is booming and exactly what their path to mastery looks like. This is the context that makes everything else click.*

The 'Why' of This Company

- Mission: We don't just sell panels — we sell financial freedom and environmental stewardship
- Vision: Powering this state with clean, affordable energy — one family at a time
- Values: Integrity, Energy, and Expertise — these aren't wall decorations, they're decision criteria
- The belief: if you genuinely believe in what solar does for families, you will succeed here

📋 *TRAINER NOTE: Pause here and ask the room: 'Why did YOU specifically apply for this role?' Let 2–3 reps answer. This surfaces the intrinsic motivation that will carry them through the first hard weeks.*

Income Projections: The Opportunity Is Real

2–3

Sales / Month

Average Rep Income

6–10

Sales / Month

Top Producer

$150K +

Annual Potential

Top 10% of reps

$300K +

Annual Potential

The 1% — year 2+

📋 *TRAINER NOTE: COMPLIANCE: Always state this disclaimer aloud: 'Earnings are not guaranteed and depend entirely on individual performance, territory, and activity level.' Solar is one of the few industries where income is directly tied to effort — no ceiling, but also no floor without the work.*

Top Performer Spotlight

TOP REP PROFILE

[Top Rep Name]

Years in Solar: [X] · Deals Closed: [X]

THEIR SECRET

"Consistency over intensity.
Show up every day, do the activity,
and the deals take care of themselves."

- Knocked doors for 30+ straight days before first deal
- Never missed a morning team meeting in Year 1
- Top 10% company-wide by Month 6

📋 *TRAINER NOTE: 'This could be you in six months. [Name] started exactly where you are sitting today.' Replace with a real rep from your office — authenticity is everything here.*

The 4 Stages of Competence: Where Are You Right Now?

1

Stage 1 — Unconscious Incompetence You don't know what you don't know. Everything feels possible. This is where you are right now — and it's a beautiful place to start.

2

Stage 2 — Conscious Incompetence The 'Pit of Despair.' You know how much you don't know, and it feels overwhelming. You will hit this by Day 3. DO NOT QUIT HERE.

3

Stage 3 — Conscious Competence You can do it — but you have to think through every step. Scripts feel mechanical. This is where consistent practice lives.

4

Stage 4 — Unconscious Competence Flow state. Mastery. You stop thinking about the framework and just connect with the homeowner. This is your 90-day target.

📋 *TRAINER NOTE: The single most important thing to tell new reps: the Pit of Despair is not a sign they're wrong for this career — it's proof the learning is working. The reps who quit in Stage 2 never find out how close they were to Stage 3.*

Classroom Ground Rules: How We Win Today

- Phones in 'Hotel' mode — charging station at the back, face down. Full attention during instruction.
- Be back from every break on time — we move fast and every minute of content connects to something in the field
- 'Ask 3 Before Me' — check your materials, ask a neighbor, then the trainer. This builds field independence.
- Notebooks out, pens moving — writing activates memory. If you don't write it, you won't remember it when a homeowner asks.

📋 *TRAINER NOTE: Model the ground rules from minute one. If you allow phones during the first session, you've set the standard for the entire week. The reps who engage most in training close more deals in the field — this is not a coincidence.*

✅ **KEY TAKEAWAY**

Your 'Why' drives your 'How.' The rep who knows why this work matters never runs out of energy for the how.

▸ **UP NEXT**

Module 1.2: Administrative Onboarding — Setting up your Solar Office so you can get paid

MODULE 1.2

Administrative Onboarding

Setting Up Your Solar Office — Systems, Tools, and Paperwork

Onboarding Checklist: Nothing Moves Until This Is Done

- ☐ Signed Independent Contractor Agreement — your legal working status
- ☐ Direct Deposit Form / W-9 — how you get paid
- ☐ CRM Login (Salesforce / HubSpot) — where your leads and pipeline live
- ☐ Proposal Tool Access (Aurora / SolarEdge) — how you build the project
- ☐ Communication Channel (Slack / Discord) — how the team stays connected

📋 *TRAINER NOTE: Open your laptops now. Walk through each item one by one — no rep leaves this section without every box checked. A rep who isn't fully set up cannot get paid, cannot log leads, and cannot run proposals. This is not optional.*

The Tech Stack: Your Three Most Important Daily Tools

📊 CRM — YOUR PIPELINE

- Where every lead, contact, and follow-up task lives
- If it isn't in the CRM, it didn't happen — period
- The quality of your notes determines the quality of your callbacks
- Log every interaction within 24 hours or the detail is lost

🔧 PROPOSAL + CANVASSING

- Proposal Tool: builds the project, calculates production, generates the financial analysis
- Canvassing App: maps your territory, tracks doors knocked, clusters your area
- These two tools together turn a neighborhood into a pipeline
- Learn them before your first field day — stumbling on tools in front of a homeowner destroys credibility

📋 *TRAINER NOTE: These tools are your professional equipment. A doctor who doesn't know how to use their instruments isn't practicing medicine — they're guessing. Know your tools before you knock your first door.*

Compensation Structure: How the Money Moves

- Commission Calculation: [Insert company formula] — paid on installed and operating systems
- Pay Cycles: [Weekly / Bi-weekly] — tied to milestone completion, not just signature date
- Milestone 1 (M1): System Installed — first payment release
- Milestone 2 (M2): Permission to Operate (PTO) — final payment release
- Timeline: Sale → Engineering → Permitting → Install → Inspection → PTO → Commission

📋 *TRAINER NOTE: Walk through a real example: 'If you close a $35,000 system today, here is exactly the money path and the timeline.' Concrete examples land better than formulas. Reps who understand the pay timeline have better expectations and fewer frustrations in weeks 2–4.*

✅ **KEY TAKEAWAY**

You are now System Ready. Every tool is active, every form is signed, and you know exactly how you get paid.

▸ **UP NEXT**

Module 1.3: Company Culture & Expectations — What it takes to win here

MODULE 1.3

Company Culture & Expectations

What It Takes to Win Here — Every Day

The Daily Schedule of a Professional Rep

1	**09:00 AM — Team Meeting & Roleplay**	Warm-up, mindset reset, objection drilling. Amateurs skip this. Professionals treat it like a pre-game locker room.
2	**11:00 AM — Area Management & Pre-Flight**	Territory review, CRM follow-up calls, proposal prep for today's appointments. High-value admin only.
3	**1:00 PM — On Doors / Lead Generation**	Prime canvassing begins. First doors of the day while energy is high and homeowners are still home.
4	**5:00–8:00 PM — Appointments & Presentations**	The evening window is the highest-closing period. Protect this time aggressively — no admin, no calls, no distractions.
5	**8:00–9:00 PM — Evening Wrap-Up & CRM**	Log all contacts, count doors and sets, identify today's losing objection, set tomorrow's first task.

📋 *TRAINER NOTE: 'Amateurs wait for the phone to ring. Professionals follow a schedule.' Post this schedule where every new rep can see it. The rep who follows this structure in Week 1 builds a habit that generates income for years.*

Weekly KPIs: The Activity That Generates the Income

150+

Door Knocks / Week

Foundation of the pipeline

10

Leads Generated

1 in 15 doors = qualified lead

5

Presentations (Sits)

1 in 2 leads becomes a sit

1–2

Sales / Week

1 in 3–5 sits becomes a deal

📋 *TRAINER NOTE: Don't focus on the 'Yes' — focus on the activity that leads to the 'Yes.' A rep who hits 150 doors every week will close deals even if their technique is average. A rep with elite technique who only knocks 50 doors will not hit their targets.*

Your Support Structure: You Are Never Alone in the Field

👔 MANAGER

- Strategy, closing support, and ride-alongs
- First call when a deal stalls or an objection is unfamiliar
- Weekly 1:1 to review pipeline and skill gaps
- Available for closing calls in the field during prime hours

⚙️ ADMIN / OPS

- Permits, install scheduling, and utility applications
- The team that converts your signature into a live system
- Your conduit to the homeowner post-sale — set expectations correctly
- Key contact for M1 and M2 milestone status updates

📚 TRAINING

- Ongoing skill development beyond Day 7
- Weekly objection drills and roleplay sessions
- Access to recorded simulations and script libraries
- The resource for technique questions your manager can't answer in the field

🤝 PEER GROUP

- The reps you train with are your first accountability circle
- Share wins, objections, and territory intel daily
- The top performers in your cohort will show you what's possible
- Protect this culture — no complaining without a proposed solution

📋 *TRAINER NOTE: Show reps where each support resource is physically located — who sits where, what the Slack channels are, and how to reach each person. Abstract support structures don't get used. Named, located, accessible people do.*

Ethics & The Non-Negotiable 'No-Go' List

- No poaching leads from teammates — territory conflicts are handled by management, not in the field
- No misrepresenting tax credits — we are not tax professionals. Always say: 'Consult your CPA.'
- No high-pressure tactics with elderly homeowners — our reputation in a neighborhood is worth more than any single deal
- Zero tolerance for dishonesty — one misrepresentation can cost the company its license in an entire county

📋 *TRAINER NOTE: Reference the company's Code of Conduct document here — give reps a physical copy and have them initial it. 'Our reputation is more valuable than your commission. One bad apple doesn't just get fired — they ruin the territory for every rep who comes after them.'*

✅ **KEY TAKEAWAY**

Protect the culture. The rep who cuts corners makes the territory harder for every rep who follows them.

▸ **UP NEXT**

Module 1.4: Solar Industry Overview — Why now, why solar, and why this state

MODULE 1.4

Solar Industry Overview

The State of the Market — Why Now Is the Best Time in History

MODULE 1.4 — SOLAR INDUSTRY OVERVIEW

The Perfect Storm: Rising Rates, Falling Costs, and Unlimited Opportunity

1. The S-Curve of solar adoption — and where we are on it right now
2. Why homeowners go solar: financial, protection, equity, and environment
3. Federal and state incentives: the 30% ITC and what it means in practice
4. Competitive positioning: how we win against national chains and local installers

Market Growth: Why the Solar Surge Is Just Getting Started

- The S-Curve of adoption: solar is in the early majority phase — the steepest, fastest-growing part of the curve
- Utility rates have risen an average of 3–5% per year for the last decade — with no sign of slowing
- The cost of solar has dropped over 90% in the last 15 years — making it accessible to mainstream homeowners
- Energy independence: post-pandemic homeowners are more focused on household resilience than any prior generation

📋 *TRAINER NOTE: 'While everything else is getting more expensive, solar is getting more accessible. That is the Perfect Storm for this industry.' Ask the room: 'What do you think happens to utility bills over the next 25 years?' Let them answer — they already know.*

Why Homeowners Go Solar: The Four Motivations

💰 FINANCIAL

- Save money starting from Day 1 — bill swap replaces the utility payment
- Fixed monthly payment vs. rising utility bill over 25 years
- Average homeowner savings: $25,000–$75,000 over system lifetime
- ROI that outperforms most traditional financial instruments

🛡️ PROTECTION

- Hedge against utility rate hikes — lock in your energy cost today
- Eliminate the variable: utilities raise rates unilaterally and without notice
- Solar as inflation protection for household operating expenses
- Especially compelling in high-rate states and TOU billing territories

🏠 EQUITY

- A solar system adds an average of $15,000–$25,000 to home value
- Buyers pay premium for homes with active, owned solar systems
- Transferable systems: new buyer benefits from remaining warranty
- A permanent improvement to the asset, not a monthly expense

🌱 ENVIRONMENT

- Reducing carbon footprint — average system offsets 100+ tons of CO_2
- Powering the home with the same energy that built the planet
- A legacy decision: many buyers cite their children and grandchildren
- The 'side benefit' that seals the deal when the math is already right

📋 *TRAINER NOTE: The key insight for reps: different homeowners lead with different motivations. BOLT types (Day 3) correspond directly to these four categories. The financial motivator is always present — the other three are layered on top based on the individual homeowner.*

Federal & State Incentives: The 30% ITC and Beyond

🏛️ FEDERAL — THE ITC

- Investment Tax Credit: 30% of total system cost directly off federal taxes
- Example: $35,000 system = $10,500 back from the IRS
- Applied in the year the system becomes operational (PTO)
- Available to any homeowner with a federal tax liability — not a deduction, a credit
- COMPLIANCE: We are not tax professionals. Always refer to a CPA for individual situations.

🏛️ STATE & LOCAL

- State rebates: [Insert local state program and amounts]
- SRECs (Solar Renewable Energy Credits): available in select states
- Net metering: sell excess power back to the grid at retail rates
- Property tax exemption: many states exempt solar added value from property taxes
- Utility company incentives: some utilities offer additional buyback or rebate programs

📋 *TRAINER NOTE: COMPLIANCE NOTE: Never quote a specific tax credit dollar amount as guaranteed. Always say: 'Based on a system of this size, the ITC calculation would typically be approximately X — but your CPA will confirm the exact figure for your specific tax situation.'*

Solar Myths Debunked: Arming You for the Field

✗	MYTH: 'Solar doesn't work when it's cloudy'	✓	**FACT: UV light penetrates cloud cover. Germany — one of the least sunny countries — is a world leader in solar production.**
✗	MYTH: 'Solar ruins your roof'	✓	**FACT: Properly installed panels actually protect shingles from UV and weather. Most installers warrant the penetration points for 25 years.**
✗	MYTH: 'Solar companies always go out of business'	✓	**FACT: Manufacturer warranties are independent of the installer. Tier-1 panels carry 25-year product and performance guarantees.**
✗	MYTH: 'Solar is only for wealthy homeowners'	✓	**FACT: Financing options mean $0 down and a monthly payment that is often LOWER than the current utility bill from Day 1.**

📋 *TRAINER NOTE: Laminate these and keep them in the field folder. When a homeowner cites a myth, pull the card and read the fact together. Shared reading creates shared belief far faster than verbal arguments.*

✅ **KEY TAKEAWAY**

The industry is unstoppable. Rising rates + falling costs + federal incentives = a window that won't stay open forever.

▸ **UP NEXT**

Module 1.5: Solar Technology Fundamentals — Speaking with technical authority

MODULE 1.5

Solar Technology Fundamentals

Speaking with Technical Authority — From Panel to Grid

MODULE 1.5 — SOLAR TECH FUNDAMENTALS

You Don't Need to Be an Engineer — You Need to Pass the Grandmother Test

1. How solar works: the complete flow from photon to power outlet
2. Key components: panels, inverters, racking, and monitoring
3. Efficiency, degradation, and the 25-year production guarantee
4. Warranties: what's covered, by whom, and for how long

How Solar Works: Photon to Power in 4 Steps

1

Step 1 — Photons Hit the Cells (DC Power) Sunlight hits the silicon cells in the panels. The photovoltaic effect releases electrons, generating Direct Current (DC) electricity.

2

Step 2 — Inverter Converts DC to AC The inverter transforms DC power into Alternating Current (AC) — the type used by every appliance in the home. This is the 'brain' of the system.

3

Step 3 — Main Service Panel Distributes Power AC power flows from the inverter to the electrical panel and powers the home just like utility electricity — instantly and automatically.

4

Step 4 — Excess Goes to the Grid (Net Metering) When the system produces more than the home uses, excess power is 'banked' with the utility as credits — drawn back at night or on cloudy days.

📋 *TRAINER NOTE: 'You don't need to be an engineer, but you must be able to explain this to a 5th grader.' Run the Grandmother Test right now: ask a rep to explain how solar works without using a single technical term. This is the standard.*

Key Components: Panels & Inverters

☀️ THE PANELS (MODULES)

- Monocrystalline: single silicon crystal — highest efficiency (20%+), best for limited roof space
- Tier 1 manufacturers: independent rating based on financial stability and quality control
- Efficiency rating: what % of sunlight hitting the panel is converted to electricity
- Higher efficiency = fewer panels needed = more roof options for the homeowner

⚡ THE INVERTERS

- String Inverter: one central unit for all panels — lowest cost, single point of failure
- Microinverters: one inverter per panel — panel-level optimization, best for shading
- Power Optimizers: hybrid approach — DC optimizer per panel feeding a central inverter
- Rep's job: match the inverter type to the roof layout and shading situation — not just the price

📋 *TRAINER NOTE: The inverter choice is one of the most common homeowner questions. Reps who can explain string vs. micro in plain language — and recommend based on the specific home — are perceived as experts, not salespeople.*

Racking & Attachment: How Panels Stay on the Roof

🔩 RACKING SYSTEMS

- Rail-based: aluminum rails span rafters, panels clip onto rails — most common residential system
- Rail-less: each panel mounts directly to roof attachment points — lower profile, faster install
- Ballasted (flat roof): no penetrations — weighted blocks hold the system in place
- Selection depends on: roof type, pitch, local wind/snow load, and aesthetics

🏠 ATTACHMENT & WEATHERPROOFING

- L-Foot attachment: connects rail to rafter through roof sheathing — the critical waterproofing point
- Flashing: metal shield around each penetration — routes water away from the hole
- Lag bolt into rafter: rated for pull-out load well beyond wind requirements in building code
- Inspection point: the attachment and flashing are what the city inspector approves — not the panels

📋 *TRAINER NOTE: Reps don't need to install systems, but they do need to handle 'What about my roof?' with confidence. The answer is: 'Our installers are certified, the attachment is code-inspected, and any penetration point is covered by our workmanship warranty.'*

System Monitoring: Proving the System Works Every Day

- Every modern system includes a monitoring portal — accessible via web browser or smartphone app
- Real-time production data: homeowner can see exactly how much power their panels are generating at any moment
- Production alerts: if a panel underperforms, the system sends an automatic notification — to the homeowner and to our service team
- The monitoring app is a closing tool: show it during the presentation — 'Your neighbor two blocks over can pull this up right now on their phone'

SCRIPT

Rep (showing app during presentation):
This is what your dashboard looks like after we go live. Right now it's 2 PM — your system would be producing about 4.2 kilowatts. You can see it live on your phone from anywhere in the world.
Homeowner:
Wait — I can actually see it working in real time?

📋 *TRAINER NOTE: Monitoring apps are one of the most effective demonstration tools in the presentation. If you have a personal install or know a homeowner who is live, pull up their app during the presentation — real production data is more convincing than any projection slide.*

Efficiency vs. Degradation: The 25-Year Guarantee

Year 1	Year 5	Year 10	Year 15	Year 25
100%	**97.5%**	**95%**	**92.5%**	**87.5%**
Full rated output	*Minimal change*	*Still strong output*	*Above guarantee floor*	*Performance floor*

0.5%/yr

Typical Degradation Rate

25 YRS

Production Guarantee

87.5%

Guaranteed Minimum at Year 25

Warranties: The 4 Layers of Protection

🔧 PRODUCT WARRANTY

- Hardware defect coverage — manufacturer backs the physical panel
- Typically 10–25 years depending on manufacturer
- Covers: cell degradation beyond spec, delamination, physical defects
- Independent of installer: if installer closes, manufacturer still covers

📈 PRODUCTION WARRANTY

- Performance guarantee: minimum output level over system life
- Typically guarantees 80–87.5% of Day 1 output at Year 25
- 0.5% per year degradation rate is the industry benchmark for quality panels
- Gives homeowner protection against panels underperforming the projections

🔨 WORKMANSHIP WARRANTY

- Installation quality guarantee — covers labor and methodology
- Typically 5–10 years from installer
- Covers: improper installation, wiring issues, component mounting
- This is the warranty most homeowners don't ask about — but should

🏠 ROOF PENETRATION

- Covers any roof damage caused by the installation penetrations
- Critical for closing hesitant homeowners worried about roof integrity
- Typically 10–25 years — often matches the product warranty
- Show this to homeowners who raise the 'it will ruin my roof' objection

📋 *TRAINER NOTE: Warranties are the single most effective trust-building tool in the presentation. A homeowner who understands all 4 layers feels protected — and a protected homeowner signs.*

What Solar DOESN'T Do: Managing Expectations Honestly

- It is NOT a battery — the system produces power but does not store it unless a separate battery (e.g., Tesla Powerwall) is added
- It does NOT work during a blackout — safety code requires shutdown when the grid goes down (prevents backfeed to utility workers). Battery backup solves this.
- It does NOT eliminate the utility connection fee — a small monthly charge remains for grid access, typically $10–20
- The battery upsell: every limitation of standard solar is solved by adding battery storage — this is your most natural upsell conversation

📋 *TRAINER NOTE: Manage expectations proactively — always. A homeowner who discovers a limitation AFTER signing feels deceived. A homeowner who was told upfront feels informed. The rep who says 'here's what it doesn't do' is trusted far more than the one who only talks about benefits.*

✅ **KEY TAKEAWAY**

Tech is reliable, proven, and improving. Understanding it deeply lets you sell with conviction instead of hope.

▸ **UP NEXT**

Module 1.6: Identity Shift — Becoming the Consultant Every Homeowner Deserves

MODULE 1.6

Identity Shift

Becoming a Solar Consultant — Mindset for Long-Term Success

Salesperson vs. Consultant: The Identity That Changes Everything

❌ THE SALESPERSON

- Talks fast — fills every silence with product features
- Pushes product regardless of whether it's the right fit
- Focuses on commission, not on the homeowner's situation
- Treats objections as obstacles to overcome
- Closes hard because the alternative is losing the sale
- Homeowner feels sold to — and talks about it to their neighbors

✅ THE CONSULTANT

- Asks questions — silence after a question means thinking, not failing
- Recommends solar ONLY when it genuinely makes financial sense
- Focuses on ROI and the homeowner's specific goals
- Treats objections as information — they reveal what the homeowner needs
- Closes naturally because the homeowner has reached their own conclusion
- Homeowner feels helped — and refers 3 neighbors without being asked

📋 *TRAINER NOTE: 'People hate to be sold, but they love to buy from experts.' The consultant frame is not just ethical — it is more effective. The top closers in this industry almost never feel like they're closing.*

I will only recommend solar if it is genuinely in the homeowner's best interest. I will be honest about savings, timelines, and technology. I represent this company and this industry with integrity. I am a professional.

— The Solar Consultant's Integrity Creed

📋 *TRAINER NOTE: Have every rep read this aloud together. Then have them sign a copy. The act of reading it aloud and signing it creates a commitment that mere listening does not. This creed also protects them legally and ethically in the field.*

Rejection Reframe: The 'No' Is Not a Dead End

- 'No' = 'Not right now' — timing, financial stress, or life circumstances that have nothing to do with you
- 'No' = 'I need more information' — an objection is a request for a better explanation
- 'No' is statistically the path to the 'Yes' — every no brings the probability of the next yes higher
- SW × 4: Some Will, Some Won't, So What — Someone's Waiting!

SCRIPT

Rep (internal, after a firm no):
That was a data point. Their bill was $180 and they had shade issues. Not the right fit today. Next.
Rep (external, 30 seconds later):
Hi — how are you doing today? I'm in the neighborhood working on some energy profiles...

Energy Management: Your Internal State Is a Closing Tool

- Protect your morning routine — the first 60 minutes of your day determines your energy ceiling for the entire day
- The 5-Minute Mourning Period: after a lost deal, allow yourself exactly 5 minutes of frustration, then close it. Not 2 hours.
- Stay in the 'Green Zone' — high energy, open body language, genuine curiosity. Homeowners feel your state before you say a word.
- Physical triggers: car playlist, pre-door breathing, shoulder roll. Build a physical ritual that activates confidence on demand.

📋 *TRAINER NOTE: Elite performers in solar are not necessarily the most technically skilled — they are the most consistently energized. The rep who shows up at door 40 with the same energy as door 1 closes 3× more deals per week than the one who drains by door 15.*

✅ **KEY TAKEAWAY**

Your mind is your #1 tool. Everything else in this program only works when the person using it believes they belong in the room.

▸ **UP NEXT**

Module 1.7: Utility Bill Mastery — The DNA of every solar deal

MODULE 1.7

Utility Bill Mastery

The DNA of a Solar Deal — Read, Analyze, and Qualify

MODULE 1.7 — UTILITY BILL MASTERY

The Bill Is the Bloodwork. Read It Like a Doctor.

1. Why the bill is the foundation of every solar deal
2. Anatomy of a bill: the data points that determine system size and savings
3. Qualification metrics: who is a strong candidate and who isn't
4. Net metering, offset, and true-up logic explained in plain language

Why the Utility Bill Is the Most Important Document in Solar

- It determines system size — the 12-month kWh usage tells you exactly how many panels the home needs
- It proves the financial benefit — the current bill amount is the benchmark for the Bill Swap calculation
- It identifies 'Utility Pain' — a homeowner paying $350/month in electricity has a visceral motivation that a $90/month homeowner doesn't
- It qualifies the customer — the bill reveals rate code, usage patterns, and whether the economics work before you spend 90 minutes presenting

📋 *TRAINER NOTE: The bill is not a document you review after the decision — it is the first thing you look at before investing any time in a presentation. A rep who runs a full presentation for a $90/month homeowner has wasted two hours for both parties.*

Anatomy of a Bill: The Two Pages That Matter

📄 PAGE 1 — ACCOUNT DATA

- Account Number and Service Address — confirms the property is eligible
- Meter Number — used for interconnection applications
- Rate Code — Residential (flat rate) vs. TOU (Time of Use) changes the savings analysis dramatically
- Current month amount due — the 'pain number' you'll return to repeatedly during the presentation

📊 PAGE 2 — USAGE DATA

- The 12-Month Usage Graph — the single most important chart on the bill
- kWh (Kilowatt Hours) — the unit of energy, not the dollar amount
- Tiered Pricing breakdown — higher tiers cost more per kWh, making solar more valuable for heavy users
- Average monthly kWh × 12 = annual usage = the number that determines system size

📋 *TRAINER NOTE: Walk through a real local utility bill on screen here. Point to each element with a cursor. Reps who see a real bill learn 10× faster than reps who only hear the description. Hand out printed sample bills for the activity.*

Qualification Metrics: Strong Candidate vs. Walk Away

✅ STRONG CANDIDATE

- Monthly bill: $150+ (ideal: $200+) — enough pain and savings potential
- Roof: less than 10 years old, minimal shading, south/west/east facing
- Credit score meets financing threshold — pre-qualify early in the conversation
- Homeowner (not renter) — must have authority to sign and approve installation

🚩 WALK AWAY FLAGS

- Mobile homes: usually cannot support installation structurally or legally
- Renters: cannot authorize installation — ask 'Do you own this home?' first
- Extensive roof damage: install will be refused by engineering — don't invest the time
- Very low usage: under 400 kWh/month — the math often doesn't work for financing

☀️ OFFSET & SIZING

- 100% offset: system designed to match annual kWh usage exactly
- 110% offset: future-proofing for EV charging or increased usage
- Golden Rule: never overbuild beyond what the utility will allow for net metering
- The goal is to eliminate the variable bill — not to produce surplus that won't be credited

💡 NET METERING LOGIC

- The 'energy bank': excess production banks credits with the utility
- Credits used at night and on cloudy/low-production days
- True-Up bill: annual reconciliation — most net metering customers owe $0–$50
- In non-net-metering states: battery storage becomes a much stronger conversation

📋 *TRAINER NOTE: The qualification conversation happens in the first 5 minutes of any interaction — not at the end. A rep who qualifies early never wastes time running a full presentation for a mobile home renter with a $90 bill.*

🎯 ACTIVITY

Activity: Bill Reading Race

OBJECTIVE: Identify the three critical numbers from a sample utility bill in under 3 minutes

10 MIN

1. Trainer hands out a sample utility bill for the local utility company
2. Rep must identify: (1) 12-month total kWh usage, (2) Average monthly cost, (3) Rate code (Residential or TOU)
3. Based on those three numbers: is this homeowner a 'Strong,' 'Possible,' or 'Walk Away' solar candidate?
4. First rep to identify all three correctly AND give a qualification decision wins — share reasoning aloud
5. Round 2: trainer shows a second bill with red flags — reps must identify the disqualifying factor

Sample Bill Analysis: What 'Good' Looks Like

[UTILITY_COMPANY] SAMPLE BILL

Account Number:	[XXXX-XXXX]
Service Address:	[123 Main St]
Rate Code:	Residential (R-1)
Current Month Bill:	$287.43
12-Month Usage:	14,820 kWh
Average Monthly kWh:	1,235 kWh
Average Monthly Cost:	$239.50

✅ ANALYSIS: STRONG CANDIDATE

Bill Amount

$287/mo ✅

Rate Code

R-1 Residential ✅

Annual kWh

14,820 kWh ✅

Usage Pattern

Consistent ✅

Qualification

PROCEED ✅

📋 *TRAINER NOTE: Replace this mock with a screenshot of the real local utility bill. Annotate with green arrows pointing to each key number. Real bills land 10× harder than mock-ups.*

Common Bill Reading Errors: What Trips Up New Reps

- Misreading 'Delivery Charge' as the total bill — the delivery charge is only one component of the total
- Ignoring commercial rate codes — if the property has a commercial meter, the solar economics and process are completely different
- Missing Page 2 — the 12-month usage graph is almost always on the back or second page; many reps never flip it
- Using the current month's bill instead of the annual average — seasonal variation can make one month look very different from the actual average

📋 *TRAINER NOTE: Run a live demonstration of each error on a projected bill. Seeing the mistake made and corrected in real time is far more memorable than hearing about it. 'This is exactly what it looks like when you get it wrong — now here's what right looks like.'*

✅ **KEY TAKEAWAY**

The bill is the bloodwork of the home. Read it before you prescribe anything — and you'll never waste a presentation on the wrong patient.

▸ **UP NEXT**

Module 1.8: Day 1 Wrap-Up — Homework, preview, and tomorrow's mission

✅ **KEY TAKEAWAY**

The bill is the bloodwork of the home. Read it before you prescribe anything — and you'll never waste a presentation on the wrong patient.

▸ **UP NEXT**

Module 1.8: Day 1 Wrap-Up — Homework, preview, and tomorrow's mission

MODULE WRAP-UP

Day 1 Wrap-Up

Recap, Homework, and Your Mission for Tonight

Day 1 Key Takeaways: The Foundation Is Set

01

The Opportunity Is Massive

Rising utility rates + falling solar costs + the 30% ITC = a market window that rewards action right now.

02

Technical Knowledge Builds Trust

A rep who can explain the system — panels, inverter, net metering, warranties — in plain language is perceived as an expert before they quote a price.

03

Integrity Is the Foundation

The Integrity Creed is not a soft value — it is the business strategy that generates referrals, protects territory, and creates a sustainable career.

04

The Utility Bill Is Your Map

Every solar deal starts with the bill. Read it before you present. Qualify before you invest 90 minutes in a homeowner who can't move forward.

Homework Assignment: Tonight's Mission

- 📄 Find your own utility bill — or a family member's or friend's. Practice identifying the 12-month kWh total, the average monthly cost, and the rate code.
- 📝 Memorize the Integrity Creed — you will be asked to recite it at the start of Day 2
- 📺 Watch: [Video Link / Title provided by trainer] — approximately 20 minutes
- ⏰ Be here at 8:50 AM tomorrow — we start Day 2 exactly at 9:00 AM with the Door Knock script

📋 *TRAINER NOTE: Make the homework specific and achievable. A vague homework assignment gets skipped. A specific one with a clear deliverable ('bring a utility bill tomorrow') gets done. The rep who does the homework on Night 1 arrives on Day 2 already ahead.*

Q&A: Open Floor

- What is still unclear from today's content?
- What are you most nervous about heading into Day 2?
- What surprised you most about the solar industry or this company?
- 'The only bad question is the one not asked — especially before you're in front of a homeowner'

📋 *TRAINER NOTE: Let this run for 10–15 minutes. The questions asked here reveal which concepts didn't land clearly and can be reinforced at the start of Day 2. Write down every question — even the ones you answer fully, because the same question will come up in the field.*

Preview of Day 2: What's Coming Tomorrow

- 🚪 The Door Opener Script — the 15-second hook that earns the conversation
- 🎭 Handling Brush-Off Objections — staying confident when the first answer is 'not interested'
- 🔁 Roleplay Bootcamp — you will knock a door at least 20 times before lunch
- 🔍 The Discovery Process — BOLT profiling and the art of finding the real motivation

📋 *TRAINER NOTE: End on energy, not relief. 'Great work today — you've built the foundation. Get some rest, do your homework, and come back tomorrow ready to talk to customers. Day 2 is where the selling starts.'*

Your future is as bright as the sun.

Today you built the foundation:
the mission, the mindset, the technology, and the map.

Tomorrow the door opens.

See you at 8:50 AM.